

Blasting off...

Two fuels are mixed together inside the engine. This makes a big explosion, which pushes the rocket into the sky.

Rocket power.....

The engine powers the rocket during the first 10 minutes of its flight.

Space speed record

In 1976, the Helios A and Helios B spacecraft reached a speed of 157,000 mph (253,000 kph), or 44 miles (70 km) a second. That is like traveling from London to New York in 1.5 minutes! This speed has never been beaten.

Quick quiz

How fast can Ariane 5 travel?



What does Ariane 5 carry into space?



What are solid rocket boosters for?

